

M11.5.5 — Strategic Alignment Review

Part 2 — Amendment A

Purpose: Refine Part 2 based on additional founder ↔ lead developer review and strategic pressure-testing.

Important:

This amendment does **not** replace Part 2.

It:

updates assumptions where better reasoning emerged.

Reason for amendment:

Post-review discussion revealed several areas where:

product reality
user expectations
trust psychology
commercial positioning

required refinement.

Amendment 1 — Auto3 Scaling Philosophy

Previous Position

Part 2 assumed:

hard validated limit = 4 cars

This reflected:

current engineering validation

but insufficiently accounted for:

product expectations.

Updated Position

The project should move away from:

hard launch cap = 4

and toward:

validation-based scaling.

Meaning:

The launch threshold should not be:

“what has currently been tested?”

but:

“what remains reliably trustworthy?”

Recommended approach:

Dedicated scaling validation milestone

Suggested:

M11.7.x – Auto3 Scaling Validation

Purpose:

Pressure-test reliability at increasing scale.

Example:

4 cars
8 cars
12 cars
16 cars

Key question:

At what point does reliability meaningfully degrade?

Launch recommendation:

select a validated threshold that feels commercially reasonable for a paid product.

Current strategic expectation:

~10–15 cars

is likely more aligned with:

user expectations.

Basic / Plus Implication

Scaling should not feel:

artificially restricted.

Recommended framing:

Basic

Validated, trustworthy range.

Example:

10–15 reliable cars

Plus

Advanced/high-volume operation.

Example:

higher validated scaling
advanced batch operation

Important:

This must feel like:

fair additional value

—not—

feature punishment.

Amendment 2 — UI Philosophy Revision

Previous Position

Part 2 deferred:

broad UI/Desktop expansion

until post-launch maturity.

Updated Position

This assumption is no longer considered aligned with:

project philosophy.

Reason:

For FH6 Farm Tool:

UI is trust infrastructure.

This product category naturally suffers from:

low trust
macro skepticism
virus suspicion
“sketchy tool” perception

A CLI-first public experience conflicts with:

premium
simple
consumer-centered
trust-first
safe-feeling

Updated Recommendation

Launch-quality UI is:

mandatory pre-launch.

Important clarification:

This does **not** mean:

overbuilt UI.

Recommended direction:

simple, premium, highly trustworthy desktop experience

Goals:

beautiful
minimal
clear
safe-feeling
easy to understand

Priority:

High.

Reason:

trust perception materially affects adoption.

Amendment 3 — M13 Expansion

Previous Position

M13 emphasized:

polish
documentation
launch readiness

but understated:

engineering refinement.

Updated Position

M13 must explicitly include:

Engineering Polish

Reason:

Late-stage testing will likely reveal:

small safety improvements
menu refinements
timing adjustments
state recovery improvements
operator friction

Examples:

extra menu safeguards
fallback navigation
safer menu reset behavior
small UX reliability improvements

Important principle:

Final polish may require:

real code changes.

This is expected.

However:

Changes should remain:

targeted
bounded
high-value
trust-improving

—not—

late-stage feature expansion.

Amendment 4 — Discord-First Launch Strengthening

Previous Position

Discord-first launch was:

recommended.

Updated Position

Discord-first launch is now considered:

strongly preferred.

Reason:

Discord directly addresses:

the project's biggest commercial weakness:

trust

Benefits include:

Trust building

Real developer presence.

Faster support

Direct communication.

Safer iteration

Controlled user group.

Better feedback loops

Feature requests and voting.

Lower launch complexity

Potential membership/paywall integration.

Important:

Discord-first also enables:

safe-to-fail launch experimentation.

Meaning:

If assumptions are wrong:

iteration cost remains low.

Amendment 5 — Complexity Philosophy Refinement

Previous Position

Part 2 emphasized:

respecting complexity.

Updated Position

Project philosophy now becomes:

Respectful of unmanaged complexity

Meaning:

Complexity itself is:

not inherently bad.

Complexity becomes acceptable when:

bounded
safe-to-fail
learnable
high-value
manageable

Decision filter:

Instead of asking:

"Is this too complex?"

Ask:

Can complexity be bounded?
Can we fail safely?
Can we learn through it?
Does value justify complexity?
Will this create momentum or overload?

Examples of acceptable complexity:

Auto4
Discord-first launch
Basic/Plus packaging
advanced Auto2

Examples of risky pre-launch complexity:

website
advanced licensing
cloud systems
payment infrastructure
overbuilt updater

all at once.

Key distinction:

The project should avoid unmanaged complexity — not complexity itself.

Final Amendment Summary

The roadmap remains:

fundamentally strong.

However, several strategic refinements materially improved alignment with:

trust
consumer expectations
commercial reality

launch quality
product psychology

Most significant changes:

UI

Moved:

post-launch
→
mandatory pre-launch

Auto3 scaling

Moved:

hard cap = 4
→
validated launch threshold

Discord-first

Moved:

recommended
→
strongly preferred

M13

Moved:

polish only
→
engineering polish included

Complexity philosophy

Moved:

conservative

→

intentionally bounded experimentation